

I am an Indian

A midnight brush with a law keeper and an exposé on the shenanigans of the 'news makers'

For us at the editorial desk at Digit, finding the right stories, testing the latest in digital technology or finding the right software for the CD month after month is an exciting adventure. An adventure that would start early every month with long brainstorming sessions, chats, meetings, interviews, references and downloads. The stories and reviews would then flow into the copydesk for their master strokes (strikes) before we are ready to go to print. There would be heated debates, exciting discussions, flashes of inspiration and, well, a few goof ups here and there. After that, there is a big sigh of relief on the day the issue closes and then we stretch ourselves long enough before we start with the next issue all over again. But as our Multimedia Coordinator, V. Ravi Shankar, recently found out, the excitement does not stop there.



Illustration: Mahesh Benkar

It was late one evening towards the end of the month, when Akhilesh, our Head of Logistics/Distribution and Ravi decided to hop into an autorickshaw and supervise the dispatch of Digit to the various points in town from the printer. They landed right in the middle of the action with copies being printed, bound, packed, labelled and loaded into waiting tempo vans. In an hour the vans were ready to move with Akhilesh and Ravi in the driver's cabin.

It was well past midnight when the vans cleared the Octroi posts in New Bombay and wended their way into town. Just as they entered Mumbai, a cop stopped the vans and walked towards them waving his torch.

He checked the documents that the driver produced. He looked unconvinced. "Packet *Kholke Dikhao*," (Open the packets) he ordered. Akhilesh and Ravi dutifully got out and dug out a brand new copy of our Cool Technology magazine for the cop's benefit. A big smile broke across his face. "Film magazine *hai kya*?" (Is this a film magazine?) he asked staring at the female model on the cover. It took Akhilesh and Ravi a while to explain to him that Digit was actually a 'campooter' magazine. He flipped the pages and seemed convinced. He let them go and they boarded the tempo with a sigh of relief. But the cop still had a quizzical look on his face and when they were ready to wave him a friendly good night, he asked, "*Phoren hai kya*?" (Is it foreign?). With a dash of pride, Akhilesh and Ravi replied, "No. Indian." ■

Aaj ki Taazaa khabar...

One of the ways we stay up on our tech toes is through newsletters created and circulated internally by the team. But with most things Digit, these too are filled with 'attitude'. See for yourself...

Hi folks,
Nothing exciting happened today. In other non events that could be called 'news' comes SLUGBOT. No, it's not a new botpack for CS, but a robot that hunts over hundred slugs an hour.
Your newsletter for the day...

Hi,
The e-mail celebrates its 30th birthday as I send this mail. It's old now but comes to you everyday with a new charming feature, a new mail which would make your day. With tech takes like this e-mail has a long way to go... Lets sing the song, gang and wish the e-mail a very happy birthday.

(Anyone ordering cakes from Monginis? hehehe *ye pet maange more :-)*)

Hi folks,
Your Technology take, your Tech lubing, a fresh serving of low cholesterol, fat-free hi-fibre tech tidbits!

Hi Folks,
I'm in no mood for inane banter here, and luckily for me, a lot has happened over the weekend. The headlines: Gates still the richest man in the world. Comes as no surprise.

Hi Folks,
Our 'old' pal Patty [Anil Patrick] is infected with Nimda (no not his PC, it's he who is infected, lol) and retired from the NL service. Now the NL is gonna be crisper and better as in the interest of the *Junta*, I am compiling the NLS, starting today.